

LOOKING CLOSER

Note names in other languages

The note names A to G are not used everywhere. German note names are slightly different from English ones, and include an H—the composer J. S. Bach used the letters of his name B A C H as a musical theme. Some countries, such as France, use “do re mi” for C D E, while for many people “do” is movable; the do-re-mi scale can start on any note.



◁ Note names in German

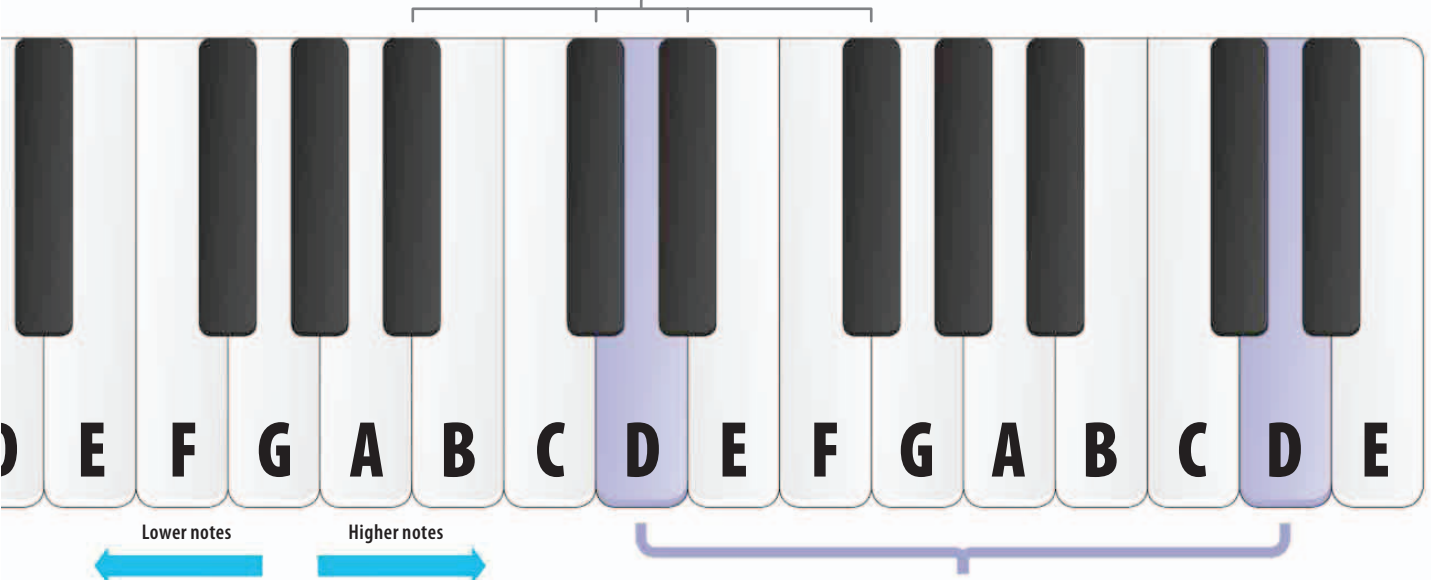
German-speaking musicians use two different note names. B in German is B♭ (the black key just below B) in English, and H in German is B in English.

▷ French, Italian, and Spanish

French, Italian, and Spanish musicians use “do re mi fa sol la si” in place of “C D E F G A B.”



The black keys are sharps and flats. They are important when we come to learning about scales and keys.



Lower notes

Higher notes

A pitch can be “low” or “high.” On a piano keyboard, this works from left to right—the highest notes are at the right-hand end of the keyboard and the lowest notes are at the left-hand end.

An octave is the distance from one note to the next one with the same letter name. These two Ds are one octave apart.

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